United States Department of Agriculture

Trade and Foreign Agricultural Affairs

Foreign Agricultural Service

1400 Independence Ave, SW
Stop 1034
Washington, DC
20250-1034

Partners of the Americas, Inc.
1424 K street NW, Suite 700, Washington, DC 20015-2410

Dear Mr. McPhail,

The U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA), Foreign Agricultural Service (FAS), is pleased to inform you that your organization's proposal for a project under the McGovern-Dole International Food for Education and Child Nutrition Program in Honduras has been preliminarily selected for funding in fiscal year 2025.

The maximum dollar value of FAS funding preliminarily approved for this proposal is **$40,000,000.00**. This amount will include U.S. provided commodity, freight, associated activity and administrative costs, and no more than $4,000,000.00 for the local and regional procurement component of the project. A USDA/FAS McGovern-Dole Program analyst assigned to negotiate the agreement will contact Partners of the Americas, Inc with additional information and to begin negotiations. Please note that the stated funding amount for the local and regional procurement component is not negotiable.

Partners of the Americas, Inc must work closely with USDA/FAS to ensure that the project terms outlined in the final agreement are in alignment with the Secretary's Memorandum on Foreign Assistance (1078-012). In particular, negotiated agreements must prioritize (1) making America safer, stronger, and more effective; (2) meeting our core objectives at USDA; and (3) ensuring a return on investment for the American farmers, ranchers, foresters, and agricultural producers who seek to support vulnerable communities around the world with the bounty of American agriculture. To support these goals, USDA/FAS expects applicants to adopt new indicators to measure the project's success in reaching these goals. These new indicators are currently under development and will be communicated to Partners of the Americas, Inc once finalized.

This letter further serves to provide written approval from USDA/FAS for Partners of the Americas, Inc to incur pre-award costs in accordance with 2 CFR 200.458 as of the date of this notification or 90 calendar days before the award agreement is signed. Partners of the Americas, Inc is authorized to incur costs that are related to the following: (1) ensuring the donated commodities that will be distributed to beneficiaries will be imported and distributed free from all customs, duties, tolls, and taxes; (2) updating and submitting to USDA/FAS an evaluation plan for approval; (3) completing a baseline evaluation within six months of the anticipated signing date of the

final agreement and before activities commence; (4) salaries and benefits for project start-up staff; (5) travel related to project start-up and agreement negotiations with USDA; and (6) other administrative costs as determined to be appropriate by USDA/FAS. Pre-award costs are not approved for any other purposes. Note that all pre-award costs are incurred at Partners of the Americas, Inc's own risk, and USDA/FAS is under no obligation to reimburse such costs if, for any reason, Partners of the Americas, Inc does not receive an award or the award is less than anticipated and inadequate to cover such costs.

Partners of the Americas, Inc must submit its request for reimbursement of pre-award costs within 60 days after the signing of the award agreement and include the appropriate documentation for reimbursement (instructions will be provided in the agreement package).

Please note that your organization may not publicly announce or publish information regarding the preliminary selection for funding or an agreement until after the award agreement is signed by USDA/FAS. If USDA/FAS and Partners of the Americas, Inc cannot successfully negotiate a final draft of the agreement by September 2, 2025, the approval of this preliminary selection for funding may be withdrawn. If you have any questions, please contact Lindsay Carter, Director, McGovern-Dole Branch, at Lindsay.Carter@usda.gov or (202) 236-1095. We look forward to working with you.

Regards,

LINDSAY CARTER-PETERSON

Digitally signed by LINDSAY CARTER-PETERSON
Date: 2025.08.21 13:41:52 -04'00'

Lindsay Carter
Senior Director, Acting
International Food Assistance Division
Foreign Agricultural Service